

Davenee A. James

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Data Analyst and BI Developer with 3+ years in higher education institutional research, specializing in PostgreSQL, MSSQL, Power BI, and IPEDS compliance reporting. Experienced in survey research, assessment support, and translating complex institutional data into decision-support tools for executive and academic leadership. Proven track record advising cross-functional stakeholders on data interpretation, KPI development, and strategic planning initiatives.

Technical Skills

BI & Analytics: Power BI (Semantic Models, Datasets, Dashboards), DAX, Power Query (M), Tableau, Data Modeling, Star Schema, Dimensional Modeling, Self-Service Analytics, KPI Development, Data Storytelling

Data Engineering: SQL (PostgreSQL, SQL Server), ETL Processes, Data Warehousing, Cloud Data Platforms, Query Optimization, Aggregation Strategies, Performance Tuning, Data Validation, Data Reconciliation

Governance & Standards: Data Governance, Naming Standards, Documentation, Data Quality, Lineage, Metric Definitions, GitHub Version Control,

Tools & Platforms: SSMS, Power Automate, SharePoint, Smartsheet, Argos Reporting, Watermark Solutions

Professional Experience

Data Analyst | BI Developer

SOUTHWESTERN ADVENTIST UNIVERSITY

May 2024 – Present | Keene, TX

- Designed and developed 10+ enterprise Power BI dashboards to measure student success, program effectiveness, and operational performance, enabling leadership to make data-driven decisions.
- Translated complex business requirements into actionable data insights, supporting strategic planning across academic and administrative departments.
- Built and maintained automated data pipelines and reporting systems, reducing manual processes and improving data accessibility for business users.
- Author federal IPEDS submissions (Fall Enrollment, SFA, ACTS, Graduation Rates) and perform data validation, data integrity checks, and root cause analysis on data discrepancies – protecting Title IV eligibility and ensuring accurate compliance reporting.
- Partnered with stakeholders to define KPIs and reporting requirements, delivering clear and impactful data visualizations for nontechnical audiences.
- Develop and optimize production PostgreSQL views against the Ellucian Colleague ODS (300+ relational database tables), applying query optimization and performance tuning.
- Implemented data governance standards and documentation, improving consistency and trust in reporting assets.
- Mentored team members and supported data literacy initiatives, helping users understand and leverage analytics tools better.
- Administer Power BI workspace governance for 15+ institutional departments — configuring access controls, dataset refresh schedules, app deployment, and standardized visualization standards (custom JSON themes) to ensure secure, consistent executive reporting across the university.

Research Assistant / Junior Data Analyst

SOUTHWESTERN ADVENTIST UNIVERSITY

August 2023 – May 2024 | Keene, TX

- Collected, validated, and analyzed institutional datasets supporting SACSCOC and IPEDS accreditation and assessment cycles, performing trend analysis and data reconciliation across multiple institutional data systems.
- Designed and administered institutional surveys using Watermark Surveys; performed instrument validation, response analysis, and reporting to support accreditation and student success initiatives.
- Identified patterns in user behavior and operational gaps, providing data-driven insights that informed process improvements and retention strategies.

Education

SOUTHWESTERN ADVENTIST UNIVERSITY

BACHELOR OF ARTS

Keene, Texas

Jan 2020 - May 2024

Certifications

- Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst Associate (In Progress)
- Project Management Foundations: Teams – LinkedIn